# VENDOR VALIDATION POLICY (v4.0) w.e.f. 12/02/2026

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## 1. Introduction

Rule 149 of General Financial Rules-2017 requires GeM to certify the credentials of GeM suppliers. GeM is conceptualized as a complete online platform, where transactions are made with minimal dependence on paper documentation, inspections, or physical verification. GeM utilizes online validations with several verified third-party databases, assessment by qualified agencies and continuous evaluation of performance on GeM for certifying the Vendor credentials. These are done at different levels.

a. The identity of the vendor, vendor turnover, GSTN registration status, company registration, Udyog Aadhar registration, DPIIT Start up registration etc. are verified through online data validations during registration, wherever the corresponding data is available with the respective databases with which GeM is integrated. Manufacturing/supply capability of vendors are validated through third party Vendor Validation Agency. Assessment of OEMs of Products by the Vendor Validation Agency is mandatory whereas assessment of re-sellers of Products by Vendor Validation Agency is optional. For definition of OEM, kindly refer to latest version of GeM's General Terms and Conditions.

b. Wherever applicable, service providers are also validated through the **Vendor Validation Agency**. Kindly refer to clause 2B(ii) for the scope of such validation.

c. **Validation of Forward Auction (VFA) buyers -** For some specified Forward Auction categories, the validation process involves confirming the authenticity of the submitted certifications / documents and organizational credentials of the bidder (Forward Auction Buyer).

d. Reliability and performance of the vendors are continuously evaluated through GeM vendor rating. This rating establishes the credentials of the vendors.

# 2. Vendor Validation

The Vendor Validation covers two distinct aspects of vendors that are captured and validated.

- Vendor Profile
- Vendor Functional Profile

## A. Vendor Profile

Information related to vendor profile, which includes personal identity, nature of business entity, financial and professional status. These are validated through online integration with respective domain databases as below. Wherever third-party domain data is not available, the information shall be validated by the third-party Vendor Validation Agency (for instance, the vendor's address information flowing from vendor's GeM profile is validated by the VA agency through the supporting documents asked to upload)

- Identity of the vendor: Online verification of AADHAAR/PAN
- Name of the key person (in case of Firm/Company): Verification of Key person done through personal information documents submitted during Seller registration.
- Company Registration: Verified through CIN validation with MCA-21
- GSTIN for vendors (wherever applicable): Through GSTN database validation
- Financial status (turnover) of the vendor: Verified through Income Tax Return.
  A vender can update their return on GeM only after 2 days of filing their ITR in the Income Tax portal. For the vendor entities who are exempted from Income Tax and are not filing their ITR, their self-declared turnover will be accepted subject to submitting the documentary evidence.
- MSME Status of OEM/Service Provider: Verified through Udyog Aadhaar
- Start- up status of the vendor: Verified through DPIIT database.

## B. Vendor Functional Profile

### i. For 'Product' Categories: 'Vendor Assessment' and 'Vendor Assessment Exemption'

To 'establish supply capability of OEM' or 'validation of OEM

authorization of re-seller', online Vendor Assessment (VA) of OEM/Reseller is carried out by GeM through a third-party Vendor Validation Agency. The validity of VA report shall be 3 years, except in those cases where any compliance document(s) submitted has / have an earlier expiry in which case the validity of the report shall be limited to the validity of the document expiring first.

All vendors shall get a fresh VA done before the expiry of the ongoing valid VA report. The name of the current third-party Vendor Validation Agency along with applicable vendor assessment (VA) fees are given in **Annexure I.**

The vendors (OEMs and re-sellers) applying for VA on GeM portal through their logged-in profile will receive a User ID, Password and a link on their Primary email ID, for navigating them to the RITES website, to proceed further with their VA application.

Once landed on the RITES website page, the vendors are advised to go through the 'instructions to vendors' shared on the RITES website, for the details & list of requisite documents as required.

The vendor assessment has two stages. The first stage is known as Desktop Assessment and the second stage is known as Video Assessment. The first stage is common for all vendors (OEMs and re-sellers). The second stage is only for OEMs.

a) **1st Stage - Desktop Assessment:** This covers verification of the documentary proofs related to the actual physical existence of the vendor, compliance to GFR 144(xi), manufacturing process flow, Compliance/Certifications as mentioned in the applied GeM category, vendor experience, authorization document from respective OEM (in case applicant is a re-seller), and any other vendor profile related information which is not validated through databases (for instance – (i) the vendor address flows from GeM profile and the same is verified on the basis of the supporting documents uploaded with VA application, (ii) vendor Turnover - in case the details from profile are not up to date the same are verified on the basis of CA certificate). Some of the compliance certifications / documents may be optional in nature in a particular category. Vendors are advised to be consistent between their VA application and subsequent catalog upload as far as category's compliance certifications / documents are concerned. Failure to do so may lead to appropriate action as per

GeM Incident Management policy by the GeM sanity team.

b) **2nd Stage – Video Assessment:** Online video assessment done to validate the Geo-tagged location of the vendor's manufacturing premise with the declared address for the manufacturing facility in the application, the production activity (for the applied category of products), manufacturing capability, and validation of the any information furnished in the Desktop assessment phase.

   For the cases where the vendor has applied for **VA in more than one categories**, however, during the video assessment stage is not able to demonstrate the production activity for all the applied products in a single time slot, then the vendor will be given an option to have a **staggered video assessment** (and select maximum 1 additional time slot) to cover the pending video assessment production activity for the remaining products).

   It may be noted that till the video assessment is done for both the time slots (if opted), the VA report will not be generated (which is a one-time action) & the vendor will not yet be recognized as an OEM for the product categories assessed during the 1st slot of the staggered video assessment.

The **Vendor Assessment Exemption (VA Exemption)** for eligible vendors is a kind of relaxation in the vendor validation process. In such a case, the video assessment (regarding vendor's line of activity for the applied category) is done away with.

A set of **VA Exemption criteria** will be available as per this policy. In case GeM modifies the VA exemption criteria, existing exempted vendors, who are affected by the change of criteria, may have to get their VA Exemption re-done within one (1) month of notification of such revised exemption criteria.

Following is the VA-Exemption criteria **applicable for re-sellers** on GeM:

a) Re-sellers, who are Registered Societies/ Trusts or any other bodies with Government Representation.

Similarly, following are the VA Exemption criteria / reasons **applicable**

**for OEMs** on GeM:

a) An OEM, who is a Central / State PSU.
b) An OEM belonging to KVIC, WDO, Coir Board, TRIFED.
c) An OEM, who is holding a valid BIS License (CML) for the product category which is validated through BIS database. The validity of this VA exemption will be 3 years or the date of expiry of the respective CML (whichever is earlier). The vendor is mandated to notify GeM in case cancellation of their BIS license following which the OEM status will be withdrawn. Further, the CML should be in the name of the applicant (except in cases of contract manufacturing setup where CML in the name of the corresponding contract manufacturer along with a valid contract manufacturing agreement / arrangement document should be provided).
d) An OEM recommended for exemption for specific categories (created specifically for the Buyer Organization(s) recommending the respective VA Exemption) for specified period by any CPSE, Central and State Government Departments/ Authorities. *The following pre-requisites shall be met for such exemptions*:

   - Vendor and List of Categories shall be recommended by Competent Authority at buyer organization for exemption. The applicant may provide this recommendation (from the respective buyer organization) in the format given as 'Annexure-IV' of the '*Guidelines and Documents for Vendor Assessment Exemption (VAE) application*', available at – Vendor Login >> My Account >> Vendor Assessment > Assessment Exemption Documents.
   - The recommendation of exemption of any vendor (corresponding to a category) shall be verified / confirmed (by the Vendor Validation Agency) with both
     - GeM Nodal officer of buyer organization
     - Category Approver at GeM – For confirmation of the buyer specific category.

e) An OEM, who is a Vaccine manufacturer as per list provided by Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.
f) An OEM, who is a Drugs/Medicine manufacturer and submits "Notarized Undertaking" & "Valid certified copy of Drug Licenses from the concerned Drug Authority."
g) An OEM, who is a Medical Device manufacturer with "Valid

Manufacturing License" from the issuing Licensing Authority.
OR
An OEM, who is the owner of a registered brand and a Medical Device importer having a "Valid Import License" from the concerned Licensing Authority.
OR
A Deemed OEM, who is a Medical Device importer having a "Valid Import License" from the concerned Licensing Authority, along with the "Deemed OEM letter" issued by the actual OEM (situated overseas), in favor of the applicant entity.

h) An OEM of automobile holding a valid CMVR (Central Motor vehicles Rules) certificate issued by the relevant authority.

In addition to the above-mentioned criteria for VA Exemption, any other category of vendors as notified with the approval of CEO-GeM can also avail VA Exemption.

**Note:** Vendors applying for VA Exemption basis any of the above reasons are advised to refer to the '*Guidelines and Documents for Vendor Assessment Exemption (VAE) application'* (for details & list of requisite documents), at – Vendor Login >> My Account >> Vendor Assessment > Assessment Exemption Documents.

**Turnaround Time (TAT) – VA and VA Exemption Applications**

The VA task is expected to be completed in 15 working days, subject to completeness and genuineness of documents and excluding the dependencies on applicants. The applicant however cannot claim any right over this TAT.

The VA Exemption task is expected to be completed in 2 working days, subject to completeness and genuineness of documents. The applicant however cannot claim any right over this TAT.

**Rejection criteria - VA and VA Exemption Applications**

- Submission with Invalid, incomplete, unreadable, expired, or mismatched certificates / documents, Incorrect / inconsistent information, any tampered / forged document, etc. may lead to rejection of the VA / VA Exemption application.
- Further, in case of Vendor Assessment, if the vendor does not respond to the non-conformities raised within the prescribed

timelines (as mentioned on RITES VA portal) the application may lead to rejection.

- The VA application shall be rejected if the vendor is eligible under any VA Exemption criteria (for the applied category).

## ii. For 'Service' Categories: Validation of Service Provider (VSP)

In this task, the designated Vendor Validating Agency assesses both compliance certifications / documents and project experience submitted by the service providers. The project experience is mandatory / optional depending on the type of service category.

**a) Scope of Validation -** Validation is carried out under two key parameters:

i. **Certification Validation** – Verification of mandatory and non-mandatory certificates relevant to the service category, including FSSAI, BIS, PSARA, MEITY, STQC, ISO, CIBRC, GSTIN, PAN, and others.

- Certificates are validated through integrated APIs (where available) or through manual verification through the issuing authority's website.
- Key checks include company name, license details, validity, state of issue, and alignment with service scope.

Any mismatch or expired or incomplete certificates, or unverifiable details result in rejection.

ii. **Project Experience Validation** – Confirmation of service providers' past work executed for Government entities.

- The Vendor Validation Agency seeks confirmation from buyer departments (based on email address provided) through email. This email is sent to the official mail of the buyer organization. In case the experience letter does not contain the official mail ID of the issuing authority, such experience letter is not taken into cognizance.
- Buyers need to confirm within 5 working days (Two reminder mails will be sent to the buyer as follow-up).
- The application will be processed on the next day following the 5th working day basis the buyer's inputs received. If -
  - Positive confirmation received from buyer → Application will be Approved
  - Negative or No confirmation received from buyer → Application will be Rejected

A Positive confirmation received from the buyer after the application has been rejected → Status will not be changed (Seller needs to be re-submit project Experience for validation.

- Only completed projects, of Government entities, concluding in last 3 financial years including current financial year (up to the date of application) are accepted. For this purpose, contracts issued by government organizations who are registered on GeM as GeM buyers (except Panchayati Raj Institutions and Co-operatives) shall only be considered.

After the Service providers' credentials (Certification and Project Experience) are validated, any further update to these shall again be subject to verification by the third-party **Vendor Validation Agency**.

**b) Turnaround Time (TAT)**

The VSP task is expected to be completed in 5 working days, subject to completeness and genuineness of documents. The applicant however cannot claim any right over this TAT.

**c) Rejection Criteria** - Applications may be rejected due to:

1. Invalid, incomplete, unreadable, expired, or mismatched certificates
2. Incorrect buyer details, unverifiable experience, or non-response from buyer departments
3. Experience irrelevant to the service scope, forged/tampered documents, or policy-specific disqualifications.

**d) Post-Rejection Provision**

Service providers may re-apply after 5 calendar days with corrected / complete documentation.

## 3. Vendor Assessment (VA) for vendors having 'Annual Turnover more than INR 500 Crore'

Vendors having an annual turnover of more than INR 500 Cr. (in any one of the last 3 financial years) are also required to apply for VA. Such vendors must ensure (before applying for the VA) that their GeM profile is updated for the turnover details.

For assessment, such applicant vendors must provide the requisite documents for –

- Their basic vendor profile detail
- Their compliance with GFR Rule 144 (xi)
- Details of their contract manufacturers (if applicable)
- Applied GeM category related certifications / documents (if applicable)

Further, their line of activity shall be assessed through video assessment.

Any other document required on the VA portal is optional for such vendors. In the absence of possessing such documents, the vendors may submit a self-declaration stating that 'the applicant is a more than INR 500 Cr. company' (which shall be validated from their profile on GeM).

## 4. Application from re-sellers: Vendor Assessment (VA) / Vendor Assessment Exemption (VA Exemption):

VA / VA Exemption applications from the re-sellers will be considered for processing only for the categories where the corresponding OEM holds a valid 'OEM dashboard' on GeM. For the applications where the corresponding OEM does not hold a valid 'OEM dashboard' on GeM, such VA / VA Exemption applications from a re-seller are liable to be rejected.

## 5. Re-assessment of Vendors:

Assessed vendors shall apply for fresh VA at least 2 months before the expiry of the existing VA. Vendors can also apply for a fresh assessment at their choice at any time on payment of requisite fee. After receipt of new VA report, the old VA report will be superseded.

Additionally, GeM reserves the right to conduct re-assessment of any vendor, even if the vendor already possesses a VA report. The result of re-assessment would override the old assessment and would be binding to the vendor.

## 6. Validation of Forward Auction (VFA) buyers on GeM:

For some specified Forward Auction categories, the validation process will be initiated when the bidder (Forward Auction buyer) applies for registration under those specified categories on the GeM portal using dedicated FA login.

Following are the specified categories (some other categories may be added in future) –

I. ELV
II. e-Waste

Upon submission, the application will automatically be routed to the Vendor Validation Agency for verification. The validation will be focused on confirming the authenticity of the submitted certifications / documents and organizational credentials of the bidder.

The Agency will validate / verify the authenticity of the submitted certificates issued by the respective competent authorities (RVSF certificates issued under MoRTH guidelines for ELV, CPCB/SPCB authorizations for e-Waste recyclers) from the respective government portals and databases. Additionally, the bidder details (name and address) will be cross-checked against the submitted certificate, GeM profile & the respective authority's portal records.

Based on the outcome of validation / verification done, the application will either be approved or rejected.

## 7. Review / Revamping of GeM Categories:

GeM undertakes the review of existing categories on a regular basis to keep them up to date as per the market practices or governing standards.

This may lead to closure of existing (old) categories and if required creation of completely new categories. However, in some cases the existing category gets evolved, and a new category is created from it.

In the case of the former, the vendors shall normally be required to undergo a fresh VA or VA Exemption (as the case may be) and a fresh application fee (wherever applicable) is to be paid by the vendors along with the new application. In the case of latter, the vendors who possess a valid VA in the old category may apply for a VA Exemption in the new (evolved) category along with submitting their valid VA report (of the old category).

## 8. Important Note for the Applicants:

A. Some categories (Eg: Toner Cartridges, Books) have additional guidelines to be followed during the VA process as per the policy. The related details are available on the portal (https://gem.gov.in/support/sellers/?lang=english) -
   - Vendor Assessment Policy for Toner Cartridges / Ink Cartridges / Consumables used in Printing machines (version 1.0)
   - Vendor Assessment Guidelines for Books(V2) category

GeM reserves the right to add or remove the categories with a special vendor assessment process.

B. Failure to respond (in a timely manner) to the queries raised by the Vendor Validation Agency may lead to rejection of the application.

C. All information in vendor profile of GeM should be up to date before applying for the vendor validation. Details of the applicant entity in the enclosed documents (wherever mentioned) should match GeM profile details.

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# ANNEXURE - I

## VENDOR VALIDATION AGENCY & FEES DETAILS

1. Name of the third-party Vendor Validation Agency: **RITES LTD.**
2. Vendor Assessment Fees to be paid directly to Vendor Validation Agency -

| **Category of Vendor** | **Fees** |
|---|---|
| i. Having turnover up to Rs.20,00,000 | Rs.871.61+ GST as applicable |
| ii. Having turnover from 20,00,001 to 1,00,00,000 | Rs.1743.22 + GST as applicable |
| iii. Having turnover above Rs.1,00,00,000 | Rs. 3486.44 + GST as applicable |

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